

Instructions for *ACL Proceedings

Anonymous ACL submission

Abstract

This document is a supplement to the general instructions for *ACL authors. It contains instructions for using the L^AT_EX style files for ACL conferences. The document itself conforms to its own specifications, and is therefore an example of what your manuscript should look like. These instructions should be used both for papers submitted for review and for final versions of accepted papers.

1 Introduction

These instructions are for authors submitting papers to *ACL conferences using L^AT_EX. They are not self-contained. All authors must follow the general instructions for *ACL proceedings,¹ and this document contains additional instructions for the L^AT_EX style files.

The templates include the L^AT_EX source of this document (acl_latex.tex), the L^AT_EX style file used to format it (acl.sty), an ACL bibliography style (acl_natbib.bst), an example bibliography (custom.bib), and the bibliography for the ACL Anthology (anthology.bib).

2 Engines

To produce a PDF file, pdfL^AT_EX is strongly recommended (over original L^AT_EX plus dvips+ps2pdf or dvi2pdf). The style file acl.sty can also be used with luaL^AT_EX and XeL^AT_EX, which are especially suitable for text in non-Latin scripts. The file acl_lualatex.tex in this repository provides an example of how to use acl.sty with either luaL^AT_EX or XeL^AT_EX.

3 Preamble

The first line of the file must be

```
\documentclass[11pt]{article}
```

¹<http://acl-org.github.io/ACLPUb/formatting.html>

To load the style file in the review version:

```
\usepackage[review]{acl}
```

For the final version, omit the review option:

```
\usepackage{acl}
```

To use Times Roman, put the following in the preamble:

```
\usepackage{times}
```

(Alternatives like txfonts or newtx are also acceptable.)

Please see the L^AT_EX source of this document for comments on other packages that may be useful.

Set the title and author using \title and \author. Within the author list, format multiple authors using \and and \And and \AND; please see the L^AT_EX source for examples.

By default, the box containing the title and author names is set to the minimum of 5 cm. If you need more space, include the following in the preamble:

```
\setlength\titlebox{<dim>}
```

where <dim> is replaced with a length. Do not set this length smaller than 5 cm.

4 Document Body

4.1 Footnotes

Footnotes are inserted with the \footnote command.²

4.2 Tables and figures

See Table 1 for an example of a table and its caption. **Do not override the default caption sizes.**

As much as possible, fonts in figures should conform to the document fonts. See Figure 1 for an example of a figure and its caption.

²This is a footnote.

Command	Output	Command	Output
<code>\a</code>	ä	<code>\c c</code>	ç
<code>\^e</code>	ê	<code>\u g</code>	ğ
<code>\`i</code>	ì	<code>\l</code>	ł
<code>\.I</code>	İ	<code>\~n</code>	ñ
<code>\o</code>	ø	<code>\H o</code>	ő
<code>\'u</code>	ú	<code>\v r</code>	ř
<code>\aa</code>	å	<code>\ss</code>	ß

Table 1: Example commands for accented characters, to be used in, e.g., BibT_EX entries.



Figure 1: A figure with a caption that runs for more than one line. Example image is usually available through the mwe package without even mentioning it in the preamble.

Using the `graphicx` package `graphics` files can be included within figure environment at an appropriate point within the text. The `graphicx` package supports various optional arguments to control the appearance of the figure. You must include it explicitly in the L^AT_EX preamble (after the `\documentclass` declaration and before `\begin{document}`) using `\usepackage{graphicx}`.

4.3 Hyperlinks

Users of older versions of L^AT_EX may encounter the following error during compilation:

```
\pdfendlink ended up in different nest-
ing level than \pdfstartlink.
```

This happens when pdfL^AT_EX is used and a citation splits across a page boundary. The best way to fix this is to upgrade L^AT_EX to 2018-12-01 or later.

4.4 Citations

Table 2 shows the syntax supported by the style files. We encourage you to use the natbib styles. You can use the command `\citet` (cite in text) to get “author (year)” citations, like this citation to a

paper by ?. You can use the command `\citep` (cite in parentheses) to get “(author, year)” citations (?). You can use the command `\citealp` (alternative cite without parentheses) to get “author, year” citations, which is useful for using citations within parentheses (e.g. ?).

A possessive citation can be made with the command `\citeposs`. This is not a standard natbib command, so it is generally not compatible with other style files.

4.5 References

The L^AT_EX and BibT_EX style files provided roughly follow the American Psychological Association format. If your own bib file is named `custom.bib`, then placing the following before any appendices in your L^AT_EX file will generate the references section for you:

```
\bibliography{custom}
```

You can obtain the complete ACL Anthology as a BibT_EX file from <https://aclweb.org/anthology/anthology.bib.gz>. To include both the Anthology and your own .bib file, use the following instead of the above.

```
\bibliography{anthology,custom}
```

Please see Section 5 for information on preparing BibT_EX files.

4.6 Equations

An example equation is shown below:

$$A = \pi r^2 \quad (1)$$

Labels for equation numbers, sections, subsections, figures and tables are all defined with the `\label{label}` command and cross references to them are made with the `\ref{label}` command.

This is an example cross-reference to Equation 1.

4.7 Appendices

Use `\appendix` before any appendix section to switch the section numbering over to letters. See Appendix A for an example.

5 BibT_EX Files

Unicode cannot be used in BibT_EX entries, and some ways of typing special characters can disrupt BibT_EX’s alphabetization. The recommended way of typing special characters is shown in Table 1.

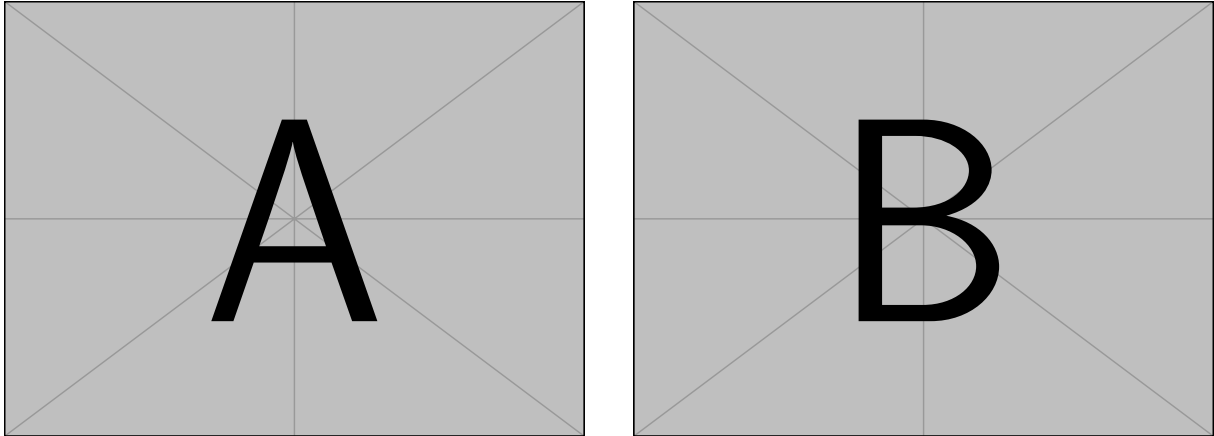


Figure 2: A minimal working example to demonstrate how to place two images side-by-side.

Output	natbib command	ACL only command
(?)	\citep	
?	\citealp	
?	\citet	
(?)	\citeyearpar	
?’s (?)		\citeposs

Table 2: Citation commands supported by the style file. The style is based on the natbib package and supports all natbib citation commands. It also supports commands defined in previous ACL style files for compatibility.

Please ensure that Bib_T_E_X records contain DOIs or URLs when possible, and for all the ACL materials that you reference. Use the doi field for DOIs and the url field for URLs. If a Bib_T_E_X entry has a URL or DOI field, the paper title in the references section will appear as a hyperlink to the paper, using the hyperref _L_A_T_E_X package.

Limitations

Since December 2023, a "Limitations" section has been required for all papers submitted to ACL Rolling Review (ARR). This section should be placed at the end of the paper, before the references. The "Limitations" section (along with, optionally, a section for ethical considerations) may be up to one page and will not count toward the final page limit. Note that these files may be used by venues that do not rely on ARR so it is recommended to verify the requirement of a "Limitations" section and other criteria with the venue in question.

Acknowledgments

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Roskovskaya, ACL 2018 by Shay Cohen, Kevin Gimpel, and Wei Lu, NAACL 2018 by Margaret Mitchell and Stephanie Lukin, Bib_T_E_X suggestions for (NA)ACL 2017/2018 from Jason Eisner, ACL 2017 by Dan Gildea and Min-Yen Kan, NAACL 2017 by Margaret Mitchell, ACL 2012 by Maggie Li and Michael White, ACL 2010 by Jing-Shin Chang and Philipp Koehn, ACL 2008 by Johanna D. Moore, Simone Teufel, James Allan, and Sadaoki Furui, ACL 2005 by Hwee Tou Ng and Kemal Oflazer, ACL 2002 by Eugene Charniak and Dekang Lin, and earlier ACL and EACL formats written by several people, including John Chen, Henry S. Thompson and Donald Walker. Additional elements were taken from the formatting instructions of the *International Joint Conference on Artificial Intelligence* and the *Conference on Computer Vision and Pattern Recognition*.

A Example Appendix

This is an appendix.